DEVELOPMENT OF A WEB-BASED QR CODE-ENABLED DOCUMENT TRACKING, ROUTING AND MANAGEMENT SYSTEM FOR THE LOCAL GOVERNMENT UNIT OF TUAO

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MASTER OF SCIENCE IN INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

Prepared by

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APPROVAL SHEET

This thesis documentation entitled Development of a Web-Based QR Code-Enabled Document Tracking, Routing and Management System for the Local Government Unit of Tuao is submitted for examination and approval. Names, signatures, institutional identifiers, and defense date must be completed by the researcher and the institution before submission.

Required approval item	To be supplied before defense
Researcher	Name and signature
Adviser	Name, credentials, and signature
Panel members	Names, credentials, and signatures
Date and venue	Official defense record

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

The researcher acknowledges the Local Government Unit of Tuao, the adviser, faculty members, participating personnel, family, and colleagues whose guidance and cooperation support the completion of this project documentation.

DEDICATION

This work is dedicated to public servants, records personnel, educators, family members, and future researchers who advocate accountable and responsive public service.

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ABSTRACT

DocTrackTuao is a Laravel and Vue web application for internal document registration, QR-supported identification, routing, receipt, processing, controlled attachment handling, history, audit logging, and reporting for the Local Government Unit of Tuao. The implementation maintains server-side authorization and office custody rules: a permitted user may act only on a document held by the user's assigned office, and processing changes are blocked while a route remains pending. The application uses Laravel API routes, Sanctum authentication, Eloquent models, Vue pages and components, Vite, MySQL, and protected local file storage. This manuscript documents confirmed implementation behavior and identifies evidence that remains necessary for a formal defense, including institutional approvals, respondent information, completed evaluation instruments, and production deployment evidence. It does not report fabricated survey scores, performance metrics, or user-test results.

Keywords: document tracking, QR code, routing, Laravel, Vue, role-based access control, local government unit

CHAPTER I. THE PROBLEM AND ITS BACKGROUND

1.1 Introduction

Government offices require reliable records of document custody, processing activity, and routing history. A paper-oriented process can make it difficult to determine which office currently holds a document, whether it has been received, and what action has been recorded. DocTrackTuao addresses this information-management need through an internal web application that links physical documents to system records through issued QR codes while preserving workflow history.

The system is designed as a local-government document workflow tool. Its confirmed functions are document registration, QR issuance and registration verification, incoming and outgoing views, forwarding and receipt, current-action and processing-note updates, attachment controls, audit logs, dashboards, accomplishment reports, and role-aware navigation. The implementation aligns its handling of personal information with the need for appropriate safeguards recognized in the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (Republic Act No. 10173, 2012).

1.2 Conceptual Framework

The study uses an Input-Process-Output framework. Inputs are authorized users, office assignments, document metadata, an issued QR code, and active lookup values. The process applies authentication, authorization, validation, custody and pending-route checks, routing, receipt, processing, audit logging, and reporting. Outputs are a current document state, controlled workflow history, QR-linked identification, and reports available within the assigned access scope.

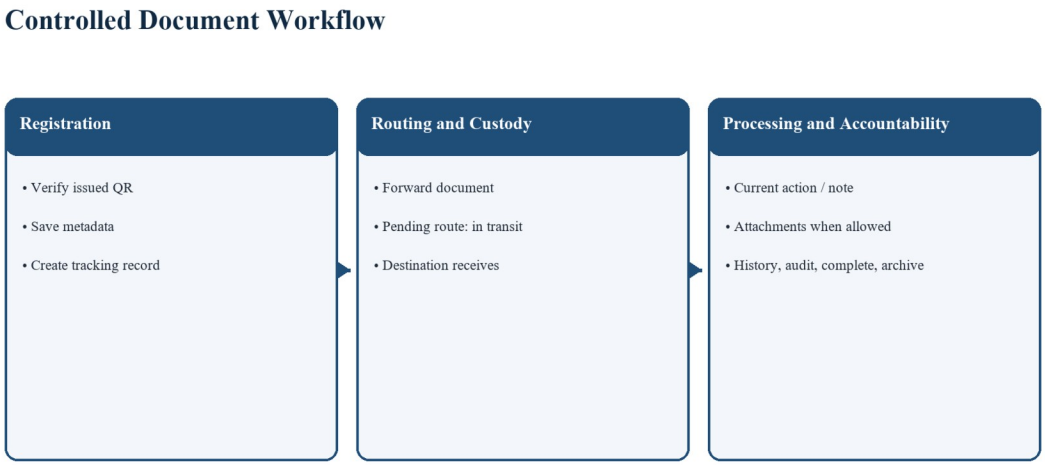


Figure 1. Controlled document workflow in DocTrackTuao.

1.3 Objectives of the Study

1.3.1 General Objective

To document and evaluate the implementation of a web-based QR code-enabled document tracking, routing, and management system for the Local Government Unit of Tuao.

1.3.2 Specific Objectives

- Document the implemented registration, QR, routing, receipt, processing, attachment, history, audit, and reporting functions.
- Document role permission and office-scope controls as implemented by Laravel routes, controllers, and models.
- Present the confirmed system architecture, data model, API surface, and test evidence.
- Identify the remaining institutional and evaluation evidence needed for formal defense completion.

1.4 Scope and Limitations

The documented scope is the internal DocTrackTuao application contained in the repository. It includes authenticated account functions, internal document workflow, QR code issuance and resolution, role permissions, office checks, attachment storage, audit logging, reports, and the Vue interface. The system does not by itself prove public internet accessibility, production HTTPS configuration, completed user evaluation, organization-wide deployment, or quantified operational improvement. Those claims require separate evidence.

1.5 Significance of the Study

For administrators, the system provides controlled reports and audit information. For records and office personnel, it provides a structured view of document custody and permitted next actions. For viewers, it provides read-only access within the established permissions. For the LGU, it provides a maintainable implementation record that can guide pilot testing, deployment, and future enhancement. For future researchers, it provides a repository-grounded case of QR-assisted internal document workflow design.

1.6 Definition of Terms

Term	Operational meaning in this study
Document custody	The office recorded as the document's current office.
Pending route	A document route that has not been received and has not been cancelled or rejected.
Office scope	The server-side restriction requiring a user's office to match the document office for relevant mutations.
Processing action	An active selected action recorded with an optional processing note.
QR record	A system-issued QR code associated with registration/tracking behavior.
Terminal status	Completed or Archived; these statuses block further processing and attachment mutations.

CHAPTER II. REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE AND SYSTEMS

2.1 Records Management and Digital Workflow

Records-management practice emphasizes reliable management of records throughout their use and retention. ISO 15489-1 frames records management around concepts and principles that support trustworthy information handling (International Organization for Standardization, 2016). In this project, separate document, routing, processing, attachment, and audit records preserve different forms of accountability rather than replacing history with a single current value.

2.2 QR Code Identification

QR identifiers can connect a physical item to a digital record without printing the full record content onto the physical label. In DocTrackTuao, QR records are generated, verified for registration, linked to a document, and resolved through defined routes. QR lifecycle behavior remains subject to backend validation and permissions; a UI control does not replace those server-side checks.

2.3 Web Application Architecture and Security

Laravel separates request routing, authentication, middleware, validation, and Eloquent data access. Its authentication documentation describes guards and providers as core authentication mechanisms (Laravel, 2026). Vue supports component-based interfaces and the Composition API used in the project's single-file components (Vue.js, 2026). The system also follows the security principle that authorization must be enforced on the server, not only by hidden controls. The Data Privacy Act of 2012 establishes the Philippine policy context for securing personal information in information and communications systems (Republic Act No. 10173, 2012).

2.4 Synthesis

The reviewed sources support an implementation that distinguishes identity, authorization, custody, workflow state, and retained history. DocTrackTuao applies that synthesis through a Laravel API guarded by Sanctum and permission middleware, a Vue presentation layer, and persistence models for documents, routes, processing logs, QR records, attachments, notifications, and audit logs.

CHAPTER III. RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Research Design

This manuscript uses a developmental documentation approach. It examines the project repository as the implementation source of truth and documents confirmed routes, controllers, models, migrations, Vue pages, tests, and database relationships. It does not infer results from code inspection alone; test outcomes are separately identified as verified or not yet verified.

3.2 Development Approach

The codebase shows iterative development across workflow, security, reporting, and interface modules. The documented approach consists of requirements interpretation, model and API design, Vue implementation, focused testing, and review. The project guide requires small closure targets, role and office-scope checks, route/history side-effect checks, and review of code changes before advancing.

3.3 System Architecture

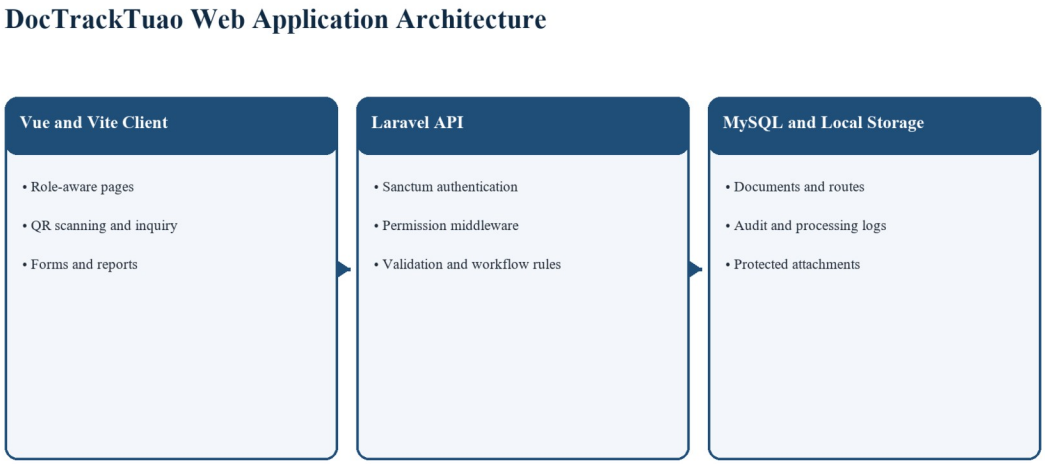


Figure 2. System architecture confirmed from the Vue, Laravel, MySQL, and attachment-storage implementation.

3.4 Role and Office-Scope Design

The User model maintains a role-to-permission map. The role answers what a user may do, while office assignment answers which currently held documents a user may act on. For processing, the current office must equal the user office and no pending route may exist. Relevant controllers return forbidden or conflict responses when these conditions are not met.

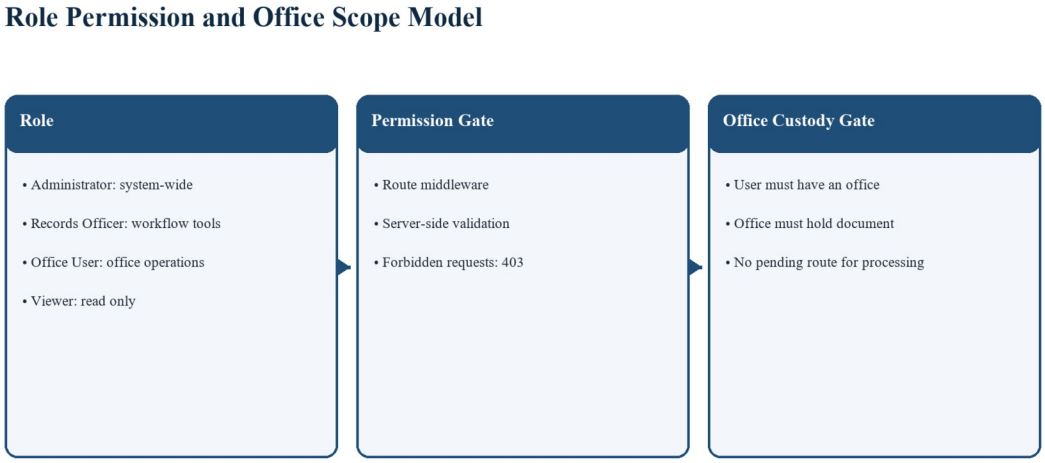


Figure 3. Role permission and office scope model.

Role	Confirmed capabilities	Important boundary
Administrator	All defined permissions, user and master-data administration, reports and audit.	Document actions still follow controller workflow checks.
Records Officer	Document registration, workflow, QR request/view/manage, audit and reports as mapped.	Role permission does not remove office-custody checks.
Office User	Document view, process, route, attachment management, QR request, reports.	No user management; mutations are office-scoped.
Viewer	Document/attachment/master-data/report reading.	No create, route, receive, process, attachment mutation, or user management.

3.5 Requirements

ID	Functional requirement	Repository evidence
FR-01	Register a document after QR verification and save its core metadata.	DocumentController and Documents.vue.
FR-02	Forward, receive, reject receipt, and undo pending forwarding subject to custody checks.	DocumentRoutingController and API routes.
FR-03	Record an active processing action and optional note only when held and not in transit.	DocumentProcessingController.
FR-04	Upload, list, download, and delete allowed attachment types under access rules.	DocumentAttachmentController.
FR-05	Show history, audit logs, dashboard, and accomplishment reporting in permitted scope.	Routing, audit, and dashboard controllers.

ID	Non-functional requirement	Implementation basis
NFR-01	Security	Sanctum authentication, permissions, validation, 403/409 enforcement, protected local storage.
NFR-02	Traceability	Routes, processing logs, QR associations, and audit logs retain workflow events.
NFR-03	Usability	Vue pages, QR input/scanner components, role-aware navigation, and confirmation dialogs.
NFR-04	Maintainability	Laravel controllers/models/migrations; Vue pages/components; focused tests.
NFR-05	Reliability	Database transactions/locks are used in custody-sensitive lifecycle paths.

3.6 Data Model

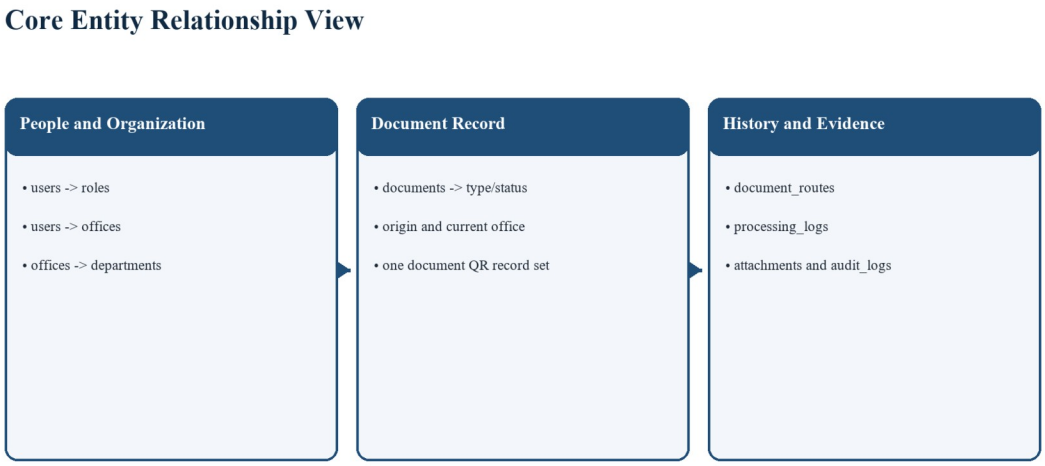


Figure 4. Core entity relationship view based on confirmed models and migrations.

Table	Key confirmed purpose	Selected relationships/fields
users	Authenticated accounts with role and office assignment.	role_id, office_id, department_id, must_change_password, deactivated_at
documents	Core tracking record and current state.	tracking_no; type/status/priority; origin_office_id; current_office_id; completion/archive fields
document_routes	Forwarding, receipt, cancellation, and rejection history.	document_id; from_office_id; to_office_id; forwarded_at; received_at
document_qr_codes	Issued/linked QR records and lifecycle data.	document_id and QR lifecycle fields
document_processing_logs	Retained processing/action events.	document_id; office_id; user_id; processing_action_id; event_type
document_attachments	Protected attachment metadata.	document_id; stored file information; uploaded_by
audit_logs	Safe activity logging.	user_id; module; action; record_id; description; IP/user agent

3.7 Use Cases and Routing Sequence

Primary Use Cases

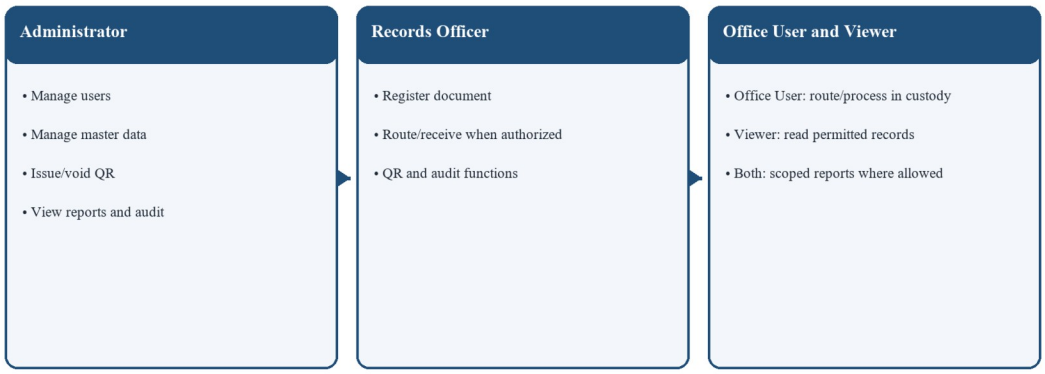


Figure 5. Primary actors and use cases.

Document Routing Sequence

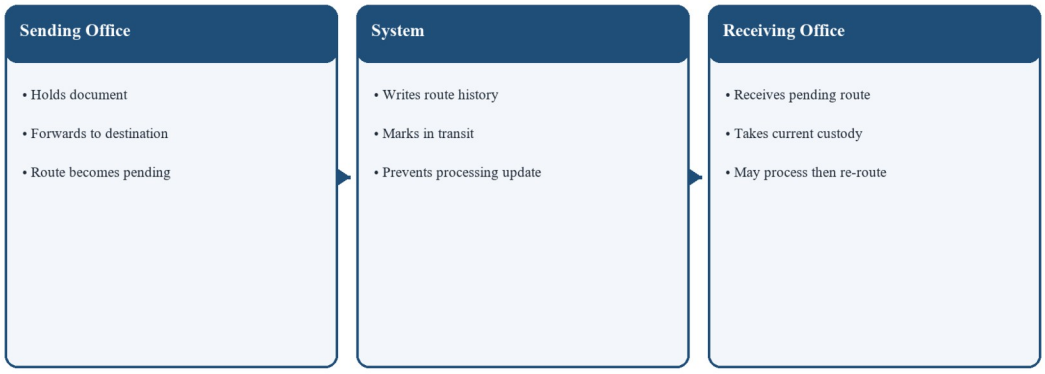


Figure 6. Document routing sequence.

CHAPTER IV. SYSTEM DESIGN AND IMPLEMENTATION

4.1 Application Modules

The Vue application includes dashboard, document registration/list/detail, incoming and outgoing views, document inquiry, QR code management, notifications, offices, user administration, audit logs, accomplishment reporting, profile functions, and report signatories. The Laravel API supplies protected routes for these modules and uses middleware to enforce authentication and permissions.

4.2 Workflow Controls

A forward action creates a route and leaves the document pending or in transit until receipt. The destination office must receive the pending route before it can update processing. The processing controller validates a selected active action, optional note length, office assignment, current custody, terminal state, and lack of a pending route. Completion requires current custody and no pending route. Archiving requires the document to be completed, currently held by the acting office, and free of a pending route.

4.3 Attachment Handling

Attachment uploads are restricted to the current office, blocked for terminal documents, and limited to PDF, Word, Excel, JPEG, and PNG files with a maximum request size of 10,240 KB. Files are placed on the local storage disk rather than the public web directory. Attachment list/download access is restricted to the current or origin office under the current controller rules.

4.4 API Endpoint Summary

Area	Selected endpoints	Access control
Authentication	POST /api/login; POST /api/logout; GET /api/user	Login public; logout/user authenticated.

Documents	GET/POST /api/documents; GET /api/documents/{id}	documents.view/create/edit/ delete permissions.
Routing	POST forward, receive, reject-receipt, undo-forward; GET history/options	documents.route/view plus controller office checks.
Processing	GET/PUT /api/documents/{id}/processing	documents.view/process plus custody and pending-route checks.
QR	GET/POST /api/qr-codes; verify-registration; resolve /api/q/{token}	Permission-specific protected functions; public resolution is throttled.
Attachments	GET/POST document attachments; download/delete attachment	attachments.view/manage plus office rules.
Administration	users, offices, document-types, audit-logs, reports	Permission middleware controls each route.

4.5 Security Design

The implementation uses Bearer-token authentication through Sanctum, middleware permission checks, server-side validation, controlled error statuses, database transactions for related workflow changes, and audit logging. Sensitive file paths are not returned by ordinary attachment list responses. The code also contains rate-limited public tracking and QR-resolution routes; before any internet-facing deployment, their data-exposure policy, HTTPS configuration, trusted hosts, and operational monitoring require an explicit security review.

4.6 Interface Evidence

This revision intentionally does not embed new live-system screenshots. A defense copy should use only a controlled local session with anonymized records and no active QR tokens, passwords, personal names, or unnecessary document contents. The repository contains Vue page implementations that provide the source of truth for the documented interface modules.

CHAPTER V. TESTING, FINDINGS, CONCLUSION, AND RECOMMENDATIONS

5.1 Testing Approach

The project guide requires focused automated checks, a positive path, a relevant forbidden or invalid path, inspection of history/audit side effects, and review of the working-tree diff. The following table contains only outcomes actually verified during the documented development session. It is not a substitute for the required end-to-end role and office testing program.

Test or check	Result	Evidence/status
Dashboard summary feature test	Passed	18 tests and 174 assertions reported in the focused Laravel test run on 10 October 2026.
QR registration frontend test	Passed	3 tests passed after Enter-key form-submission handling adjustment.
Document lifecycle frontend test	Passed	15 tests passed for complete/archive behavior and related source checks.
Production frontend build	Passed	Vite production build completed after the most recent UI changes.
Complete end-to-end role matrix	Not yet verified	Do not claim complete until all roles and wrong-office paths are exercised.
ISO/IEC 25010 respondent evaluation	Not yet verified	No completed questionnaires or validated dataset supplied.
Production/LAN security deployment	Not yet verified	Requires HTTPS, host, backup, and deployment evidence.

5.2 Findings

Repository inspection confirms an implemented internal document workflow with QR association, routing history, receipt, controlled processing, protected attachments, audit support, reports, and role/office controls. The strongest implementation constraint is

the combination of role permission and office custody. Code inspection also confirms that front-end visibility is not the sole authorization mechanism; protected routes and controller checks govern mutations.

5.3 Conclusion

DocTrackTuao provides a documented technical foundation for controlled internal document tracking in the Local Government Unit of Tuao. Its implementation separates the current document state from retained routing and processing history and applies server-side permission and office-custody rules to workflow mutations. The project is suitable for a defense discussion of its implemented architecture and workflow, provided that evaluation claims remain limited to verified evidence.

5.4 Recommendations

- Complete the full register-to-archive end-to-end test across Administrator, Records Officer, Office User, and Viewer accounts, including wrong-office and pending-route denial cases.
- Collect institutional approval, respondent profile, completed ISO/IEC 25010 instruments, and an auditable analysis dataset before reporting evaluation scores.
- Prepare a fresh database backup before any real-user pilot, then verify restore procedures and access controls.
- Before LAN or internet deployment, complete the focused security hardening and deployment checklist, including trusted hosts, HTTPS where applicable, authentication lifecycle, storage protections, and server backup procedures.
- Capture final screenshots only in a controlled environment with anonymized information.

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APPENDICES

Appendix A. Repository Evidence Reviewed

Evidence group	Examples used in this documentation
Project guidance	AGENTS.md workflow, role, office-scope, backup, testing, and security rules.
Backend	routes/api.php; document, routing, lifecycle, processing, attachment, dashboard, audit, and QR controllers.
Models and migrations	Document, DocumentRoute, User, attachment, processing, QR, audit models and migration inventory.
Frontend	Vue pages/components for documents, details, tracking, QR, dashboard, reports, navigation, and authentication.
Tests and API reference	Focused frontend tests, Laravel tests, and api-tests/API-ENDPOINTS.md.

Appendix B. Information Required Before Institutional Submission

Required item	Why it is needed
Researcher, adviser, panel, signatures, defense date	Required front-matter and approval-sheet information.
Approved research title and degree wording	Institution-specific title-page compliance.
Respondent count, profiles, consent/approval, and completed instruments	Required for any survey/evaluation claim.
Validated calculation sheet for ISO/IEC 25010 results	Required before weighted means or verbal interpretations.
Pilot/deployment evidence and backup/restore record	Required before claiming operational rollout or production readiness.
Anonymized final screenshots	Optional visual evidence for the final defense manuscript.

Appendix C. Selected Workflow Rules

Processing updates require a valid assigned office, current custody by that office, an active action, and no pending route. Forwarded documents remain pending until received. Completion requires the acting office to hold the document and no pending route. Archiving requires the document to be completed, held by the acting office, and free of a pending route. Completed and archived documents cannot receive processing or attachment mutations.

Appendix D. ISO/IEC 25010 Evaluation Instrument Status

An evaluation instrument may be attached after it is approved by the institution. No completed respondent responses, weighted means, rankings, or compliance scores are included in this manuscript because they were not supplied for verification.

Appendix E. Source Code Areas

Area	Repository location	Purpose
API routes	routes/api.php	Defines public and protected endpoints plus permission middleware.
Role permissions	app/Models/User.php	Defines the application role-to-permission map.
Processing enforcement	app/Http/Controllers/DocumentProcessingController.php	Enforces office custody and no-pending-route processing rules.
Lifecycle enforcement	app/Http/Controllers/DocumentLifecycleController.php	Enforces completion/archive state transitions.
Routing enforcement	app/Http/Controllers/DocumentRoutingController.php	Handles forward, receive, receipt rejection, and undo behavior.
Document interface	resources/js/pages/Documents.vue and DocumentDetails.vue	Supports registration and controlled document actions.

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